

Word family: buy / buys / bought / buying / buyer / buyout / buyback

Base word: buy

Past tense / past participle: bought

-ing form: buying

Person noun: buyer

Useful family extensions: buyout, buyback, buying power, buyer's market

Important fixed expressions: buy time, a good buy, buy someone's silence, money can't buy..., buy one get one free

Part of speech: verb(動詞) / noun(名詞)

Your sentence:

“One advertisement that persuaded me to **buy** a product was a TV commercial for a pair of noise-cancelling headphones.”

A full family sweep shows that **buy** has one central literal meaning—**obtain something in exchange for money**—but several important figurative and extended meanings have developed from that idea.

The major useful modern senses are:

1. purchase something;
2. acquire a company/business/assets;
3. accept or believe an explanation/story;
4. obtain cooperation, silence, loyalty, time, etc. by giving something in return;
5. noun **a buy** = a purchase, especially a good/bad deal;
6. business/finance extensions such as **buyer, buyout, buyback, buying power**.

Meaning in your passage

Here, **buy** means:

to obtain the headphones by paying money for them.

繁體中文：付款取得某件商品的所有權；購買

Natural translation:

“...persuaded me to buy a product...”

「.....說服我去購買一件產品.....」

So here:

buy = 付錢取得商品／產品

1. **buy + product/item** (商品／物品) — 買; 購買

This is your original meaning.

Meaning: To obtain something by paying money for it.

Practice 1 — Original

“The advertisement persuaded me to **buy** the product.”

「那則廣告說服我去購買那件產品。」

Practice 2

“I **bought** a new pair of headphones yesterday.”

「我昨天買了一副新耳機。」

Practice 3

“Where did you **buy** that laptop?”

「你在哪裡買那部手提電腦？」

buy something = 付款取得某件商品或物品的所有權

2. **buy + food/drink/ticket/service** (食物／飲品／票／服務) — 購買; 付款取得

The thing bought does not need to be a permanent physical possession.

Practice 4

“I **bought** a train ticket online.”

「我在網上買了一張火車票。」

Practice 5

“She **bought** us coffee.”

「她買咖啡請我們喝。」

buy = 付款取得商品、服務、票券、食物或其他有價值的東西

This is still the core literal purchasing sense.

3. **buy + person + something** — 買某物給某人；請某人

A useful grammar pattern.

Practice 6

“I’ll **buy you lunch**.”

「我會請你吃午餐／買午餐給你。」

Practice 7

“She **bought her brother a birthday present**.”

「她買了一份生日禮物給弟弟。」

buy someone something = 付款購買某物並把它提供／送給某人

Equivalent pattern:

buy something **for** someone

4. buy + company/business/property/assets (公司／ 業務／資產) — 收購；買下

Meaning: To acquire ownership of a business, company, property, or major asset by paying for it.

Practice 8

“The larger company **bought** the smaller firm.”

「較大的公司收購了那間較小的企業。」

Practice 9

“They **bought** the building for five million dollars.”

「他們以五百萬美元買下了那棟大樓。」

buy — business/property = 透過付款取得公司、企業、物業或大型資產的所有權

The Chinese often becomes:

- buy a company → 收購公司
 - buy a house → 買樓／買房
 - buy land → 購置土地
-

5. buy = believe / accept a story, explanation, excuse (說法／解釋／藉口) — 相信；接受

This is a genuinely different figurative meaning.

Practice 10

“I don’t **buy** his excuse.”

「我不相信／不接受他的藉口。」

Practice 11

“Do you really **buy** that explanation?”

「你真的相信那個解釋嗎？」

buy — figurative = 接受某個說法、解釋、故事或藉口為可信／合理

This is informal but very common.

Compare:

“I don’t buy it.”

= 我不信／我不接受這套說法。

It does not mean:

我不買它。✗

unless the context is literally shopping.

6. buy someone’s silence/cooperation/loyalty (沉默／合作／忠誠) — 用金錢／利益換取；收買

Meaning: To obtain someone’s cooperation, silence, loyalty, support, etc. by giving them money, advantages, or rewards.

Practice 12

“They tried to **buy his silence**.”

「他們試圖用金錢或利益收買他，讓他保持沉默。」

Practice 13

“Money cannot **buy genuine loyalty**.”

「金錢無法買到真正的忠誠。」

buy + abstract quality/behaviour = 用金錢、利益或其他回報換取某人的行為、支持或態度

Depending on context, Chinese may be:

- 收買
 - 換取
 - 買到
-

7. **buy time** — 爭取時間; 拖延以換取更多時間

A very important fixed expression.

It does **not** mean literally purchasing time.

Practice 14

“The temporary repair **bought us some time.**”

「臨時維修替我們爭取了一些時間。」

Practice 15

“He asked another question to **buy time** before answering.”

「他再問了一個問題，好讓自己爭取時間／拖延一下再回答。」

buy time = 透過某個行動延遲事情發展，為自己取得更多準備、思考或處理時間

This is one of the most useful figurative uses of **buy**.

8. **money can't buy + abstract quality** (幸福／愛／尊重) — 金錢買不到.....

This is a common conceptual extension.

Practice 16

“Money can’t **buy** happiness.”

「金錢買不到幸福。」

Practice 17

“Respect cannot simply be **bought**.”

「真正的尊重不能單靠金錢買到／換取。」

buy + abstract thing = 用金錢或利益取得某種抽象價值；常用於否定句表示某些東西不能真正靠金錢獲得

9. **buy = secure a result/advantage by spending resources** — 換取；取得

A broader figurative extension.

Practice 18

“The extra investment **bought** the company greater flexibility.”

「額外投資為公司換來了更大的彈性。」

Practice 19

“A small delay may **buy** us a better outcome.”

「短暫延遲可能替我們換取一個更好的結果。」

buy — figurative = 付出金錢、時間、努力或其他資源，以換取某個有利結果

This is broader than literal purchasing.

10. **a buy = something purchased** (名詞) — 買到的東西；一次購買

Here, **buy** becomes a noun.

Practice 20

“That jacket was my best **buy** this year.”

「那件外套是我今年買得最值得的一件東西。」

Practice 21

“The headphones were an expensive **buy**.”

「那副耳機是一筆比較昂貴的購買。」

a buy = 一次購買，或買回來的某件物品

11. a good/bad buy — 划算／不划算的購買

A very common noun construction.

Practice 22

“At that price, the headphones are a **good buy**.”

「以這個價錢來說，這副耳機很值得買／很划算。」

Practice 23

“The old car turned out to be a **bad buy**.”

「那部舊車最後證明是一宗不划算的購買。」

a good buy = 以價格、品質和實用性來看很值得購買的東西

a bad buy = 買得不值得／性價比差的東西

12. buyer = person/company that buys something — 買家；購買者

Practice 24

“The house attracted several potential **buyers**.”

「那間房子吸引了幾名潛在買家。」

Practice 25

“Online **buyers** expect fast delivery.”

「網上購物者／買家期望快速送貨。」

buyer = 付款購買商品、資產或服務的人／企業

13. **buyer** = professional purchasing employee (企業採購) — 採購員; 買手

A distinct workplace meaning.

Practice 26

“She works as a fashion **buyer**.”

「她是一名時裝買手／採購員。」

Practice 27

“The store’s **buyer** selects products for the next season.”

「店舖的採購員／買手負責挑選下一季的產品。」

buyer — profession = 代表公司或零售商選擇並採購商品的專業人員

This is especially common in:

- retail
 - fashion
 - wholesale
-

14. buying = activity/process of purchasing — 購買；採購活動

Practice 28

“Online **buying** has become more common.”

「網上購物／購買行為變得更普遍。」

Practice 29

“The company centralized its **buying**.”

「公司把採購工作集中管理。」

buying = 購買商品、服務或資產的活動／過程

15. buying power / purchasing power — 購買力

A very useful economic extension.

Practice 30

“Inflation reduces consumers’ **buying power**.”

「通脹會降低消費者的購買力。」

Practice 31

“Higher wages can increase household **buying power**.”

「較高工資可以提升家庭的購買力。」

buying power = 某個人／家庭／群體的收入或資產實際能夠購買多少商品和服務的能力

16. buyer's market — 買方市場

A useful business/real-estate expression.

Meaning: A market in which supply is high relative to demand, giving buyers greater choice or bargaining power.

Practice 32

“Falling demand has created a **buyer's market**.”

「需求下降形成了買方市場。」

Practice 33

“In a **buyer's market**, customers may be able to negotiate lower prices.”

「在買方市場中，顧客可能更容易議價。」

buyer's market = 供應相對較多、買家較有選擇和議價能力的市場

Contrast:

seller's market = 賣方市場

17. buyout = purchase of controlling/full ownership — 收購; 買斷

A major business family extension.

Practice 34

“The company agreed to a management **buyout**.”

「公司同意進行管理層收購。」

Practice 35

“The deal resulted in a complete **buyout** of the smaller firm.”

「這宗交易最終令較小的公司被完全收購／買斷。」

buyout = 購買一家企業或某項權益的大部分／全部所有權，從而取得控制

18. **buyback** = company repurchasing something previously sold/issued — 回購

A very useful finance/business extension.

Practice 36

“The company announced a share **buyback**.”

「公司宣布進行股份回購。」

Practice 37

“The retailer offers a device **buyback** programme.”

「零售商提供裝置回購計劃。」

buyback = 原出售者／發行者重新把已出售或發行的產品、股份等買回來

Two common contexts:

- share buyback = 股份回購
 - device buyback = 裝置回購
-

19. **buy one, get one free** / **BOGO** — 買一送一

A very common retail expression.

Practice 38

“The shop has a **buy one, get one free** offer.”

「這間店有買一送一優惠。」

Practice 39

“The drinks are **buy one, get one free** today.”

「今天飲品有買一送一優惠。」

buy one, get one free = 購買一件商品後免費獲得另一件相同／指定商品

Useful abbreviation:

BOGO

especially in American retail English.

20. **buy** = financial-market purchase (股票／資產) — 買入

In investing/finance, **buy** is commonly used as a technical market verb.

Practice 40

“Investors began to **buy** shares after the price fell.”

「價格下跌後，投資者開始買入股份。」

Practice 41

“The fund decided to **buy** more government bonds.”

「基金決定買入更多政府債券。」

buy — finance = 在金融市場購入股票、債券或其他資產

Still fundamentally the purchasing meaning, but the specialized Chinese is often 買入.

21. a buy = investment recommendation to purchase (金融) — 買入評級／買入建議

Another noun use in finance.

Practice 42

“The analyst rated the stock a **buy**.”

「分析師給予該股票買入評級。」

Practice 43

“The shares were upgraded from hold to **buy**.”

「該股票的評級由『持有』上調至『買入』。」

a buy — investment = 分析師認為某項資產值得購買的投資評級／建議

This is domain-specific but common enough to recognize.

Important distinction: buy vs get

We just redid **get**, and this contrast is essential.

buy

specifically means money is exchanged.

“I bought the headphones.”

「我花錢買了耳機。」

get

means obtain by any method.

“I got the headphones.”

Could mean:

- bought them;
- received them as a gift;
- obtained them from work;
- acquired them another way.

So:

buy $\subset$ **get**

Buying is one way of getting something.

Important distinction: buy vs purchase

They mean essentially the same literal action, but register differs.

buy

everyday, natural.

“I bought a phone.”

purchase

more formal/business-like.

“The customer purchased a phone.”

「顧客購買了一部電話。」

As nouns:

a purchase is much more common/formal than noun **a buy** in neutral contexts.

But:

a good buy

is very natural.

Important distinction: buy vs pay

buy

focuses on obtaining the product.

“I bought the headphones.”

pay

focuses on giving money.

“I paid \$200 for the headphones.”

So:

buy + thing
pay + amount
pay for + thing

Correct:

“I bought the headphones for \$200.”

“I paid \$200 for the headphones.”

Important distinction: buy vs afford

buy

= actually purchase.

afford

= have enough money/resources to be able to purchase.

“I can afford the headphones.”

「我買得起這副耳機。」

does not mean:

“I bought them.”

You can afford something and choose not to buy it.

Important distinction: buy vs shop

buy

= complete the purchase.

shop

= look for/consider things to buy.

“I went shopping but didn’t buy anything.”

「我去逛街購物，但最後甚麼都沒有買。」

So **shopping** does not guarantee **buying**.

Important distinction: buy vs believe

For figurative **buy**:

“I don’t buy his story.”

≈

“I don’t believe his story.”

But **buy** is:

- more informal;
- often slightly skeptical/challenging.

It can imply:

我不接受你這套說法。

Important distinction: buyer vs customer

buyer

= the person/entity actually making the purchase.

customer

= someone buying from or using a business, often as part of an ongoing customer relationship.

In property:

buyer = 買家

not usually:

customer.

In a café:

customer = 顧客

more natural than **buyer**.

Important distinction: buyer vs consumer

buyer

= purchases the item.

consumer

= ultimately uses/consumes the item.

They may be different people.

Example:

A parent buys headphones for a child.

Parent = **buyer**

Child = **consumer/user**

Important distinction: buyout vs acquisition

buyout

usually emphasizes buying enough/all ownership to take control.

acquisition

broader business term for one company acquiring another company/business/assets.

Every buyout is a kind of acquisition, but not every acquisition is normally called a buyout.

Important distinction: buyback vs refund

buyback

the seller/company purchases the item/shares back.

refund

your payment is returned because a transaction is reversed, cancelled, defective, etc.

phone buyback = 公司把舊電話買回去

refund = 退款

Not the same.

Grammar note: bought

The irregular forms are:

buy → **bought** → **bought**

Not:

buyed ❌

Examples:

“I **bought** it yesterday.”

“I have **bought** it already.”

Family-extension note

After the full family sweep, the useful modern family includes:

- **buy — product/item** = 購買
- **buy someone something** = 買某物給某人／請某人
- **buy — company/property** = 收購／買下
- **buy — believe** = 相信／接受某種說法
- **buy someone's silence/loyalty** = 用利益收買／換取
- **buy time** = 爭取時間
- **buy + abstract benefit** = 以資源換取某種結果
- **a buy** = 一次購買／買到的東西
- **a good/bad buy** = 划算／不划算的購買
- **buyer** = 買家／購買者
- **buyer — profession** = 採購員／買手
- **buying** = 購買／採購活動
- **buying power** = 購買力
- **buyer's market** = 買方市場
- **buyout** = 收購／買斷
- **buyback** = 回購
- **buy one, get one free** = 買一送一
- **buy — finance** = 買入
- **a buy — finance** = 買入評級